

Apex Systems - RFP Response: Enterprise Procurement Platform

Executive Summary

Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native procurement platform built on a microservices architecture with proven scalability to 50,000+ concurrent users. We understand the requirement for a resilient, auditable, and secure evaluation system.

Proposed Solution & Implementation Approach

Architecture uses Kubernetes-orchestrated microservices, event-driven integration via Kafka, and a PostgreSQL cluster with read replicas. REST and GraphQL APIs support integration with existing ERP systems. Horizontal auto-scaling is configured for peak load.

Timeline, Team Structure, and Milestones

18-week delivery: Weeks 1-3 discovery and architecture sign-off, Weeks 4-10 core build, Weeks 11-14 integration and security testing, Weeks 15-18 UAT and go-live. Team of 9: 1 delivery lead, 2 architects, 4 engineers, 1 QA lead, 1 security engineer.

Price Table with Assumptions

License + implementation: \$420,000 (Year 1), \$95,000/year thereafter. Assumes standard integration scope (3 systems), 40 named admin users, and client-provided test environments. Change requests billed at \$185/hour.

Security, Compliance, and Risk Controls

SOC 2 Type II certified, ISO 27001 certified. Data encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). Full audit logging with 7-year retention. Annual third-party penetration testing with reports available on request. Role-based access control with SSO/SAML support.

Support Model, Relevant Experience, and References

24/7 tier-1 support with a 1-hour critical response SLA. Delivered similar platforms for 3 Fortune 500 procurement teams in the last 4 years. References available from a global logistics client and a national retail chain upon request.